

FORMAL LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to provide my strongest recommendation for Mr. Mo Maaz for admission to advanced academic programmes at leading universities in the United Kingdom, India, Australia, Canada, or South Africa, within the fields of Mining Engineering, Metallurgy, Mine Planning, or Mining-related Financial and Strategic disciplines.

Mr. Maaz has been employed by Saudi Gold Refinery (SGR) since 15 September 2024, serving as MIS Officer – Mining Operations & Production Performance. In this role, he operates at the intersection of exploration, mining operations, metallurgical processing, and financial performance reporting, supporting senior management across a diversified portfolio of assets.

In addition to operational mining and processing activities, Mr. Maaz is actively involved in exploration reporting across a portfolio of sixteen (16) active exploration licenses. This includes consolidated reporting and performance tracking for exploration programmes supported by an internal and contracted drilling capability comprising approximately twenty (20) drill rigs. His work integrates drilling progress, metres drilled, budget performance, contractor productivity, and programme scheduling, linking exploration outcomes to downstream technical studies and strategic decision-making.

Despite not holding a completed Commerce (B. Com) degree, Mr. Maaz has demonstrated exceptional technical aptitude and intellectual discipline. He has independently developed a sophisticated understanding of complex exploration, mining, and metallurgical systems, including drilling and sampling workflows, production reconciliation across mining and processing circuits, stripping ratio and grade analysis, recovery optimisation, and cost-performance relationships across the value chain.

Of particular note is his ability to design and implement advanced management information systems using modern AI-driven tools. He consistently translates highly technical geological, drilling, mining, and metallurgical data into concise, decision-ready insights for executive leadership, while preserving technical accuracy and operational context. His work reflects an uncommon ability to bridge engineering-level detail with financial and strategic analysis.



Beyond analytical capability, Mr. Maaz has shown strong commitment to understanding mining and exploration activities physically and practically. Through site exposure and direct engagement with exploration teams, mining engineers, geologists, and metallurgists, he has developed an applied understanding of drilling operations, mining cycles, metallurgical processes, and operational constraints—an attribute that significantly enhances his academic readiness for advanced theoretical study.

I would further note that, in my professional career, I have recommended and supported a number of candidates for postgraduate and executive education who have gone on to excel at leading global institutions, including Harvard Business School, Stanford Graduate School of Business, Stellenbosch Business School, the University of Cape Town Graduate School of Business, and Prince Mohammed Bin Salman College of Business & Entrepreneurship (MBSC). This experience provides me with a strong benchmark for academic readiness and long-term leadership potential. Mr. Maaz compares very favourably against this cohort.

Mr. Maaz combines intellectual curiosity, technical self-development, strong work ethic, and professional maturity. His understanding of the interaction between exploration results, mining processes, metallurgical performance, cost structures, and value creation positions him as an outstanding candidate for rigorous academic study at a top-tier institution.

I recommend Mr. Mo Maaz without reservation and am confident he will add meaningful value to any academic programme or research environment he joins.

Should further information be required, I would be pleased to provide it.

Yours sincerely,

Nico de Lange CA(SA), MBL (UNISA)
Chief Financial Officer (CFO)
Saudi Gold Refinery (SGR)

Direct contact details withheld for privacy